Backbone Detectives · Pupil Resources

Learning goal: I can use inside body clues to sort tricky animals and explain my choice.

Arrival Questions (In your book)

1. Does a snake have a backbone inside?
2. Does a worm have a backbone?
3. What supports a beetle's body?
4. Can you ask an adult to help?

Starter Question

A mystery animal has no legs. Can it still have a backbone?

A. Yes, if it has a line of bones inside like a snake.

B. No, every animal with a backbone must have four legs.

C. Only if it lives in a tree.

Method Strip

1. Lay out the Vertebrate mat and the Invertebrate mat.
2. Pick a tricky creature card and read the inside clue. STOP AND CHECK with your adult.
3. Place the card on the matching mat.
4. Sort all eight cards and check if any outside clue tricked you.
5. Write or say your proof for two animals in your book.

Exit Ticket

What one clue proves an animal is a vertebrate?

Sort a snake and a crab, and give the clue for each.

Why can outside appearance lead to a sorting mistake?